

STAGE FOUR • MINDSET, PRODUCTIVITY & HABITS

FIRSTS

DISCUSSION PROMPTS

Open-ended questions to seed group conversation beyond the worksheets

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

BY AYOMIDE AYENI

FIRSTS • Discussion Prompts

Stage Four • Mindset, Productivity & Habits

PURPOSE

Individual worksheets answer “what's your routine, your KPIs, your affirmation?” These prompts answer a different question: “what's your real, lived experience trying to actually sustain a habit or mindset practice?” They're open-ended and personal, meant to seed conversation beyond a simple share-out of worksheet answers.

Use these during share-out portions, when a session finishes its planned agenda with time to spare, or when a group's energy needs a genuine, specific prompt rather than “any volunteers?” They're organized by session, four prompts each.

This stage's content tends to surface genuine vulnerability — rejection, self-doubt, abandoned habits. Read the room before pushing for a full-group share on any of these; a pair or small-group version often works better than a full round.

Prompts by Session

SESSION 1

Mindset Foundations

"What's a moment recently where you genuinely didn't feel confident but acted confident anyway? What happened?"

"Has keeping any kind of journal or written record ever surprised you by revealing a pattern you hadn't noticed?"

"What's a rejection or setback you've actually recovered from well, and what did that recovery actually look like day to day?"

"Where does your own to-do list usually go wrong — too many urgent tasks, or too few important ones getting scheduled?"

SESSION 2

Sustaining Systems

"What's a stress management technique you've tried that genuinely worked, even if it sounds unusual?"

"Have you ever had an accountability partner or check-in relationship that actually changed your behavior? What made it work?"

"What time of day are you genuinely at your best, and does your current schedule actually protect that time for anything important?"

"Has an affirmation or self-talk practice ever felt genuinely useful to you, or has it always felt hollow? What's the difference?"

SESSION 3

Extra Edge / Standout Factor

"What's a side project or personal pursuit you've always wanted to start but haven't? What's actually stopped you?"

"Has a volunteer or impact experience ever taught you something about yourself that a job or class didn't?"

"What's a genuine opinion you hold about your field that you've never actually said out loud to anyone in it?"

"Looking at your strategic goal sheet, which single goal, if you actually hit it, would change the most for you?"